

■ Endless Scroll Effect

■ What is it?

People forget to stop scrolling when content keeps loading.

When platforms keep showing new posts, users continue scrolling, telling themselves they'll stop after "just one more."

For example, it's like eating popcorn during a movie—you don't realize how much you've eaten until the bowl is empty.

■■ History

The concept of **endless scroll** became popular in the 2010s with the rise of social media feeds.

It's based on behavioral psychology principles, especially the **variable reward loop**, where people keep checking because they don't know what exciting thing will appear next.

This design quickly became a standard for engagement-driven apps like Twitter, Instagram, and TikTok.

■ The Psychology Behind It

- Our brains are wired to look for **rewards and novelty**.
- Each scroll feels like "maybe the next one will be even better."
- This triggers dopamine, creating a **loop of continuous engagement**.

While this boosts time on platforms, it can also lead to **fatigue and overuse**.

■■ Why It Matters

Endless scroll can:

- Keep users engaged longer
- Reduce friction compared to clicking "next"
- Drive more ad views and interactions

But it can also:

- Cause addictive behavior
- Lead to burnout or fatigue
- Hurt mental health with overuse
- Frustrate users who lose track of progress

■ How to Apply It

- **Personalize feeds** → show content that matches user interests.
- **Add stopping points** → “Load More” buttons or pagination.
- **Show progress** → scroll indicators or section markers.
- **Give control** → let users switch between scrolling and pagination.
- **Encourage breaks** → prompts to pause after long sessions.
- **Enable saving** → bookmarking or “save for later” features.

■ Theory in Action

- **TikTok** uses endless scroll to keep users watching short videos, each promising something new.
- **Shopping malls** often design layouts without clear exits, encouraging people to keep exploring and discovering more products.

■ Final Thought

Endless scrolling can boost engagement and make experiences feel smooth—but it can also drain users.

Smart design balances engagement with well-being, keeping users active but not exhausted.